

## Chapter 17

Yin Lingzhu glanced at Yan Si in the audience below. Yan Si happened to be looking at her too, their eyes meeting just like when they first met.

The bright lights overhead illuminated the stage. Yin Lingzhu composed herself and parted her lips gently.

The microphones used on stage were of excellent quality. In the audience's ears, Yin Lingzhu's voice was clear and smooth, without a trace of static.

Though it was clearly a song about heartbreak that should have carried a sad and melancholy atmosphere, from Yin Lingzhu's mouth it carried liberation and freedom.

As if she was saying, "I've let you go."

As the climax arrived, Yin Lingzhu's voice lowered, carrying a slight magnetic quality. Different from the initial carefree tone, it was now full of reluctance to let go.

Yin Lingzhu's bangs swayed gently in front of her forehead, the slightly longer strands brushing over her upper eyelids. Her brows furrowed lightly, showing melancholy and pain.

Her grip on the microphone tightened, the bones at her finger joints clearly defined, veins visible on her pale hands - fragile yet alluring.

Silently inviting every audience member.

Yan Si watched Yin Lingzhu on stage. At this moment, the stage lights seemed to favor her, enveloping her as if she herself was glowing.

Yan Si lifted her hand from the table, tracing Yin Lingzhu's features through the air.

She felt that Yin Lingzhu at this moment was so far away, as if she might leave her the next second.

Yin Lingzhu was responsible for the opening two lines and the climax, while Wan Miaoyin and Kong Murui handled the other parts.

After the last lyric was sung, the entire venue fell silent.

Noticing this scene, Yin Lingzhu licked her lips that had become dry from exertion, hiding her inner nervousness.

But immediately after, the entire venue erupted in thunderous applause, proving how perfect the performance had been, which calmed her heart.

The host walked to Yin Lingzhu's side, also applauding.

"Little Yin's voice was filled with emotion in this performance, moving every audience member present."

Hearing the host mention "filled with emotion," Yin Lingzhu paused. When she was singing, she only felt that today went much more smoothly, not realizing she had put any particular emotion into it.

Except for...

Her gaze moved to Yan Si.

Except that when she was singing today, her mind was entirely filled with thoughts of Yan Si.

The host's voice in her ears gradually faded away, and now only Yan Si remained in her vision.

Today Yan Si wore a black dress. The velvet material made Yan Si seem untouchable, with the word "noble" written all over her.

Her face carried its usual smile, but the smile didn't make Yan Si seem approachable - instead, it made her seem even more unreachable.

Yin Lingzhu forced her gaze away from Yan Si and looked toward the big screen.

This competition was the grand finale, with only two groups remaining.

One group was Yin Lingzhu's trio, the other was a solo performer.

The screen showed the audience voting results. Thanks to Yin Lingzhu's outstanding performance, her group's votes were far ahead.

As the host counted down "three, two, one," the voting stopped.

"Congratulations to Yin Lingzhu, Wan Miaoyin, and Kong Murui for winning this championship!" The host's excited voice rang out, and the audience below applauded once again.

Yin Lingzhu's gaze swept over the audience. In the sea of people, she could see support banners<sup>1</sup> that belonged uniquely to her, and fans holding glow sticks with sparkling eyes full of affection.

She loved the feeling of standing on stage - the accelerated heartbeat and blood rushing through her veins made Yin Lingzhu feel an adrenaline rush, thrilling and exciting.

In her previous world, she had never had the chance to experience this feeling. In this life, how could she not seize it?

"Special guest Yan Si will present them with their awards." The host stepped down from the stage.

Yan Si, holding the golden trophy, slowly walked to Yin Lingzhu's side.

"Congratulations." Yan Si's smile was more genuine than before as she handed the trophy to Yin Lingzhu.

Yin Lingzhu reached out to take it, quietly lowering her voice near Yan Si's ear, "I'll come to the apartment to find you tonight."

Yin Lingzhu paused, wanting to say more, but realizing she was very close to Yan Si, her open mouth remained silent for a moment before closing.

Hearing Yin Lingzhu's words, Yan Si's eyes lit up. She thought Yin Lingzhu wanted to reconcile with her.

Yan Si also nodded slightly.

Since Yan Si was only responsible for presenting awards, she could leave the stage quickly.

Returning to the apartment, Yan Si carefully selected from her wardrobe.

She had moved most of her clothes here, and now the wardrobe was packed full, completely different from the initial sparse scene.

Although the room hadn't changed much overall, Yan Si had made small adjustments to various details, so at least it no longer looked like a model home.

Yan Si looked left and right in the wardrobe, finally choosing a thin white chiffon dress.

Even though she didn't know when Yin Lingzhu would come, Yan Si felt happy during the waiting time.

Yan Si sat on the balcony, looking down from the window, eagerly awaiting Yin Lingzhu.

Just like how Yin Lingzhu used to wait for her.

The sun set, night fell, and the oval moon hung in the center of the sky.

Yan Si didn't see any sign of Yin Lingzhu.

Her gaze swept over other apartment buildings, watching lights turn on in household after household.

She then took out her phone and saw the time - 11:03 PM.

She had waited for Yin Lingzhu for five hours.

Yan Si felt wronged, her eyes reddening.

This was the first time she had waited for someone this long.

Though it was summer, the evening breeze through the window still made one feel cold.

Yan Si hugged herself, sensing the chill in the air.

She opened her messaging app, found Yin Lingzhu's chat window, and tentatively sent a message.

【When are you coming】

As expected, there was a red exclamation mark in front.

She pursed her lips and found Yin Lingzhu's phone number.

She clicked the call button.

【Hello, the number you have dialed is busy, please try again later...】

It was a busy tone.

Yin Lingzhu still hadn't removed her phone number from the blacklist.

Yan Si's eyes became even redder. Why was she still blocking her?

The white chiffon dress fluttered in the wind, adding an air of vulnerability to Yan Si.

After Yan Si left, Yin Lingzhu had originally thought she could arrive at the apartment shortly after Yan Si, but looking at the production team in front of her, she smiled helplessly.

"Little Yin, tonight we plan to celebrate for you all. You must come!" The director looked at her with a beaming smile.

"Director, I might..." not be able to go.

Before Yin Lingzhu could finish her sentence, she was nudged by Yang Daiyi beside her.

Yin Lingzhu could only keep quiet and nod.

Looking at Yang Daiyi and the director chatting enthusiastically, Yin Lingzhu had no choice. She took out her phone, wanting to tell Yan Si not to wait.

Looking at her phone battery, it was only at ten percent - she had to charge it.

"Hello, we're your fans. Can we take a photo with you?" Just as Yin Lingzhu was looking for a charger, she heard someone speaking beside her.

"Of course." Yin Lingzhu looked at the two girls in front of her, nodded, and smiled.

But Yin Lingzhu had clearly underestimated how many people wanted photos - it wasn't just two.

Afterward, Yin Lingzhu maintained a smiling expression while taking photos with everyone.

By the time it ended, Yin Lingzhu's face was stiff from smiling.

After confirming no one else wanted photos, Yin Lingzhu left to find Yang Daiyi. On the way, she felt like she had forgotten something.

Yin Lingzhu looked at her phone and slapped her forehead - she had forgotten to charge her phone.

She hurried to find a staff member and borrowed a charger.

The production team first took them to a restaurant. After dinner, Yin Lingzhu thought it was over.

Unexpectedly, they then took them to a KTV.

Yang Daiyi left after dinner due to work commitments.

Yin Lingzhu also wanted to leave, but the production team wouldn't let her.

In the KTV, the production team members were clearly having too much fun, singing terribly.

While the production team members were all singing, and Yin Lingzhu and Kong Murui were also singing, only Wan Miaoyin was quietly eating from the fruit platter.

The director loved drinking but didn't like drinking alone, so he set his sights on Wan Miaoyin.

"Little Wan, come on, drink." The director came to Wan Miaoyin's side with a bottle and glass.

Yin Lingzhu noticed and stepped forward to take the glass placed in front of Wan Miaoyin.

"Director, I'll drink for her." Without waiting for the director to say anything, she immediately downed it.

After Yin Lingzhu finished drinking, the director shouted "Good!"

Then the director's target for forcing drinks changed, persistently making Yin Lingzhu drink.

After Yin Lingzhu had drunk several glasses and saw the director was obviously drunk, she told Wan Miaoyin to watch the director's condition while she went outside for some fresh air.

Yin Lingzhu took out her phone and looked at it - 11:03 PM.

She remembered what she had forgotten earlier - it wasn't charging her phone, but telling Yan Si not to wait for her.

Looking at Yan Si's number, after much hesitation, she still chose not to remove the blacklist.

With Yan Si's proud nature, how could she possibly wait for her that long?

If there was a chance next time, she would explain.

Yin Lingzhu put her phone back in her pocket and returned to her private room.

The moon in the night sky was particularly bright.

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### Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> **Support banners** (應援燈牌): In Chinese fan culture, these are illuminated signs or banners that fans hold up at concerts and events to show support for their favorite performers. They often feature the artist's name or encouraging messages.